

International Transfers or Differentiated Carbon Prices?

Abstract

Recent proposals for international carbon pricing differentiate national carbon prices by income. The usual justification is that cross-border transfers are politically infeasible. But differentiated prices are themselves equivalent to transfers. We show that any schedule of national autarky prices is distributionally equivalent to a uniform price combined with a certain allocation of tradable emission rights, equal, to first order, to each country's emissions under autarky. In a dynamic setting, the equivalent rights are weighted by the discounted carbon price, and under Hotelling pricing they reduce to a carbon budget. Because abatement costs are convex, this allocation leaves every country weakly better off, so the uniform price with equivalent rights Pareto-dominates autarky. We quantify the equivalence in NICE, an integrated assessment model with 179 countries. Replacing the schedules of [Parry et al. \(2021\)](#), [Wolfram et al. \(2025\)](#), or [Banerjee et al. \(2025\)](#) with a uniform price and equivalent rights would cut the coalition's emissions by 4–5% while leaving every member as well off. Alternatively, holding emissions fixed, it would raise every member's consumption by about 0.05%, half the implicit transfers of differentiation: differentiation loses about half a dollar of consumption for every dollar of implicit transfer. We also review the departures from standard assumptions that could justify price differentiation and argue that they are less compelling than often thought.

Keywords: carbon pricing; international climate agreements; emissions trading; burden sharing; differentiated carbon prices; international transfers; integrated assessment.

JEL: Q54; Q58; H23; F53; D61.

1 Introduction

International climate policy is stuck on a distributional question: who should obtain the rights to emit? The Paris Agreement endorses common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities, and it commits developed countries to financing climate action in developing ones. It does not translate these principles into numbers, and national contributions remain far short of its temperature goal (UNEP 2025).

A prominent recent answer is to coordinate carbon prices while differentiating them by income. The IMF proposes an international price floor of \$75, \$50 and \$25/tCO₂ for high-, upper middle- and lower-income countries (Parry et al. 2021). Wolfram et al. (2025) propose a climate coalition built on the same tiers. Banerjee et al. (2025) propose a “grand bargain” in which low- and middle-income countries adopt prices of \$10 to \$50/t in exchange for compensation for their climate damages. In all three proposals, carbon revenues are retained domestically. Differentiation is meant to deliver equity without the cross-border transfers that are deemed politically infeasible (Parry et al. 2021).

Textbook theory prescribes something else: a uniform price for efficiency, and lump-sum transfers for equity (Aldy and Stavins 2012). Differentiated prices are a second-best substitute for transfers, and the case for income-based differentiation therefore rests on the premise that transfers are infeasible. This paper argues that the premise does not rest on solid ground. Survey evidence already challenges it: majorities accept an international carbon price financing North–South transfers in all 23 surveyed countries (Fabre 2025; Fabre et al. 2025). Furthermore, a uniform price can achieve efficiency while remaining distributionally equivalent to differentiated prices. We make the claim precise in three results.

26 First, any schedule of differentiated autarky prices is distributionally equiva-
27 lent to a uniform price combined with a specific allocation of tradable emission
28 rights. To first order, this allocation grants each country the emissions it has un-
29 der autarky. A country allowed a price below the uniform price therefore receives
30 more rights than it emits at the uniform price, and sells the difference. Con-
31 versely, positive price gap is equivalent to less emission rights. In a static setting,
32 we derive a second-order formula for equivalent rights in terms of the price gap
33 and the price elasticity of emissions (Proposition 1).¹

34 Second, granting each country its emissions under the schedule leaves every
35 country weakly better off under the uniform price than under autarky (Proposi-
36 tion 2). This is the familiar gains-from-trade logic of emissions markets (Mont-
37 gomery 1972), which Fleurbaey et al. (2025) also apply to differentiated prices at a
38 fixed cap, and the international analogue of production efficiency (Diamond and
39 Mirrlees 1971). Its implication for the policy debate is less familiar: any price-
40 differentiation agreement can be replaced by a uniform price with an allocation
41 of rights such that no country loses. The resulting surplus can take the form of
42 reduced emissions or of increased consumption.

43 Third, in a dynamic setting the equivalence holds in present value, with each
44 year's rights weighted by the discounted carbon price (Proposition 3). When
45 the carbon price follows a Hotelling path, the equivalent allocation is a carbon
46 budget: each country's cumulative emissions under autarky.

47 We quantify the equivalence in NICE (Young-Brun et al. 2025), an integrated
48 assessment model with 179 countries, in two exercises. First, for eight diverse
49 economies, we compare aggregate consumption (or welfare) under a differen-

¹We use the terms *rights* and *allocation* interchangeably: while *rights* refers to a cap-and-trade framework, our analysis equally applies to revenue *allocation* in a carbon tax.

50 tiated autarky price and under a global uniform price with a given allocation,
51 holding global emissions on a path that exhausts a carbon budget of 1000 GtCO₂
52 over 2025–2100. For each autarky price and each allocation, we compute the wel-
53 fare difference and trace the indifference curve between the two regimes. The
54 curves show that the equivalence runs only one way: many allocations of rights,
55 including an equal per capita allocation, cannot be replicated by any schedule of
56 non-negative prices, because a zero price is not enough to compensate low emit-
57 ters. For example, Nigeria prefers a uniform price to any non-negative autarky
58 price, including a zero price, as long as its rights per capita are at least 25% of the
59 global average.

60 Second, we compute the equivalent rights for prominent differentiated-price
61 proposals. Granting all members their equivalent rights cuts coalition emissions
62 by 3.9% (Banerjee et al. 2025), 4.8% (Parry et al. 2021; Wolfram et al. 2025) and
63 13.4% (Equal Right 2023), while leaving every member’s consumption as high as
64 under the schedule. Alternatively, the surplus raises every member’s consump-
65 tion by 0.05–0.06% (0.19% under Equal Right). These efficiency gains are about
66 half the implicit transfers of differentiation: under the schedule of Banerjee et al.
67 (2025), gross implicit transfers amount in present value to 0.11% of the coalition’s
68 consumption, against an efficiency gain of 0.05%. Differentiation thus loses about
69 half a dollar of consumption for every dollar of implicit transfer.

70 We make three contributions. First, while the separation of efficiency and eq-
71 uity under lump-sum transfers and the gains from permit trading are well known
72 (Chichilnisky and Heal 1994; Fleurbaey et al. 2025; Montgomery 1972; Sandmo
73 2007), we derive, in closed form, the correspondence from a given price schedule
74 to the allocation of rights that reproduces its distributive outcome. Second, we

75 quantify the equivalence for actual proposals, including the implicit transfers of
76 differentiation. Third, we find that, when revenues are pooled globally and re-
77 turned to countries in proportion to population, as in [Equal Right \(2023\)](#), adding
78 differentiation can leave the lowest emitters worse off than an already redistribu-
79 tive uniform price regime.

80 The remainder of the paper is organised as follows. Section [2](#) reviews the ra-
81 tionales for differentiated carbon prices in a world that departs from standard
82 assumptions. Section [3](#) derives the equivalence between differentiated prices
83 and emission rights, in closed form in the static case and under additional as-
84 sumptions in the dynamic case. Section [4](#) uses NICE to trace, for seven major
85 economies, the rights that leave each one indifferent to any given autarky price.
86 Section [5](#) computes the rights equivalent to prominent differentiated-price pro-
87 posals, and the emissions cut or consumption gain obtained by replacing them
88 with a uniform price. Section [6](#) concludes.

89 **2 Why differentiate carbon prices?**

90 With complete markets and no other distortion, efficiency requires a uniform
91 carbon price, and equity should be addressed via lump-sum transfers ([Sandmo](#)
92 [2007](#)). Four departures from standard assumptions have been invoked to jus-
93 tify differentiating carbon prices across countries or sectors: divergent discount
94 rates, pre-existing distortive taxes, market power in trade, and constraints on
95 cross-country transfers. We review them in turn.

96 First, [Anthoff et al. \(2026\)](#) show that equalising carbon prices across countries
97 is inefficient in case of “cross-country differences in discount rates (or interest

108 rates)”, which arise from inefficiencies in the allocation of capital. By Hotelling’s
109 argument, each country’s carbon price should grow at its own discount rate, so
100 prices cannot be equal at all dates.² The authors stress, however, that whether
101 permit trade would then raise or lower welfare depends on its interaction with
102 capital-market frictions, which no model has yet specified.

103 Second, pre-existing tax distortions can be mitigated by differentiating carbon
104 prices across sectors or countries (Babiker et al. 2004; Boeters 2014). For example,
105 if aviation remains under-taxed, a higher carbon price on aviation than on other
106 sectors improves welfare. Applying this logic to countries, Babiker et al. (2004)
107 show that a uniform price is not necessarily beneficial to the countries that take
108 part in it. However, D’autume et al. (2016) show that a uniform price remains
109 optimal if the other tax (such as a gasoline tax) addresses a local externality or if
110 public goods have to be funded by distortive taxation.

111 Third, large countries have market power in world markets, which gives them
112 a terms-of-trade motive to differentiate (Babiker 2005; Boeters 2014). Take China,
113 a large oil importer and manufacturing exporter. By taxing oil more heavily than
114 other goods, China would depress world oil demand and hence the oil price,
115 improving its terms of trade. Similarly, it has an interest in setting a higher carbon
116 price on manufactured goods, to raise the price of its exports (to the extent that
117 the carbon price paid by importers outweighs the exports lost to higher prices).

118 Fourth, and most commonly, differentiated prices are justified by the assertion
119 that international transfers are politically infeasible (Parry et al. 2021; Young-Brun
120 et al. 2025). Bauer et al. (2020) describe an “efficiency–sovereignty” trade-off in
121 climate policy: either carbon prices are differentiated and efficiency is lost, or a

²Differentiated prices may then be optimal in a second-best world, but the first best is in principle attainable by correcting the capital-market imperfections themselves.

122 uniform price with transfers is applied, hampering national sovereignty. This
123 reasoning assumes that international transfers constitute a stronger infringement
124 on sovereignty than coordinated price differentiation (see also Bekkers and Car-
125 iola 2022). Fleurbaey et al. (2025) formalise it: when transfers are ruled out or
126 permit endowments are fixed, differentiated prices, including within a carbon
127 market, can be efficient and socially preferable to a uniform price. The first three
128 rationales have an efficiency basis and do not rest on the absence of transfers.
129 They also call for a differentiation that bears no systematic relation to income: by
130 discount rate, by sector or by market power. This paper addresses the fourth ra-
131 tionale, the one invoked by differentiation proposals. We show that it cannot rest
132 on the distributional implications of transfers, since differentiation is equivalent
133 to transfers of the same size as those that a uniform price with equivalent rights
134 would involve.

135 **Related literature.** Our analysis builds on the literature that evaluates specific
136 differentiated price floors. In a global general equilibrium model, Chateau et al.
137 (2024) find that the IMF’s international carbon price floor (Parry et al. 2021) achieves
138 higher welfare than a uniform price *without transfers* attaining the same emission
139 reductions (at \$56/t), since it shifts part of the mitigation effort from low- to high-
140 income countries. He et al. (2024) show that, relative to national pledges, the IMF
141 price floors bind on developing countries such as China and India but not on
142 high-income countries, which makes the arrangement unattractive to developing
143 countries.

144 Le Moigne et al. (2026) find that income-differentiated floors do not neces-
145 sarily yield fairer outcomes. Compared with a uniform tax accompanied by
146 the North–South transfers that equalise costs across countries (\$107–169 billion

147 a year), all variants of the IMF floor entail larger global real-income losses, and
 148 most of them require larger transfers to reach the same fairness. We provide the
 149 first mapping from such schedules to equivalent allocations of emission rights.

150 Our results also speak to the literature on negotiating a common carbon price
 151 or a global cap-and-trade with revenue sharing (Cramton et al. 2017; Fabre 2024;
 152 Gollier and Tirole 2015; Grubb 1990; Nordhaus 2015; Weitzman 2014). The equiv-
 153 alence formula gives climate negotiators a closed-form “exchange rate” between
 154 price concessions and emission rights.

155 3 The equivalence between differentiated prices and 156 emission rights

157 3.1 Static setting

158 Consider countries $i = 1, \dots, I$ with populations N_i , in a single period. Lower-
 159 case variables are per capita. Country i emits e_i at abatement cost $a_i(e_i)$, which is
 160 decreasing and convex in e_i . Facing a carbon price p , firms and households emit
 161 $e_i(p)$, optimising by equating the marginal abatement cost to (minus) the price:
 162 $a'_i(e_i(p)) = -p$. Consumption is

$$c_i = y_i - a_i(e_i) + t_i, \quad (1)$$

163 where y_i is potential output and t_i a net international transfer. Welfare is increas-
 164 ing in c_i and decreasing in global emissions through climate damages.

165 We compare two regimes that deliver the same global emissions $E = \sum_j N_j e_j$,
 166 whose world average per capita is $\bar{e} \equiv E/N$ (where N is the world population).

167 Damages are then identical across regimes, and a country is better off in one
 168 regime if and only if its consumption is higher.

169 **Autarky (differentiated prices).** Country i applies a domestic price p_i , keeps its
 170 revenue and receives no transfer. It emits $e_i^A \equiv e_i(p_i)$, and $\sum_i N_i e_i^A = E$.

171 **Uniform price.** The same countries apply a uniform price p^* and trade emission
 172 rights under a cap equal to E . Country i receives rights r_i per capita. At the
 173 market-clearing price, $\sum_i N_i e_i(p^*) = E$, and i emits $e_i^* \equiv e_i(p^*)$. Its net transfer is
 174 the value of its sales minus its purchases of rights, $t_i = (r_i - e_i^*) p^*$.

175 Throughout, a star denotes the uniform-price regime, a superscript A the au-
 176 tarky regime and a bar a world average. We write $\pi_i \equiv p_i/p^*$ for country i 's
 177 relative price, and $\varepsilon_i \equiv -\frac{p^*}{e_i^*} e_i'(p^*)$ for the price elasticity of its emissions at the
 178 uniform price. Define

$$b_i \equiv a_i(e_i^A) - a_i(e_i^*) - a_i'(e_i^*) (e_i^A - e_i^*) \geq 0. \quad (2)$$

179 b_i is the deadweight loss of the price wedge $p_i - p^*$, i.e. the Harberger triangle
 180 of country i : the area enclosed by the country's marginal abatement cost curve,
 181 the horizontal line at p^* and the vertical line at e_i^A . Formally, b_i is the Bregman
 182 divergence of a_i between e_i^A and e_i^* . It is non-negative by convexity, and strictly
 183 positive if a_i is strictly convex and $p_i \neq p^*$.

184 Denote by r_i^* the *equivalent rights* that leave country i exactly as well off under
 185 the uniform-price regime as under the autarky regime with a price p_i .

186 **Proposition 1** (Equivalent rights). *Holding total emissions at E and the carbon price*

187 at p^* , we have

$$r_i^* = e_i^A - \frac{b_i}{p^*}. \quad (3)$$

188 To first order in the price gap,

$$r_i^* \approx e_i^A \approx e_i^* \left[1 + \varepsilon_i(1 - \pi_i) \right]. \quad (4)$$

189 To second order, with ε_i evaluated at p^* ,

$$r_i^* \approx e_i^A - \frac{(e_i^A - e_i^*)^2}{2 \varepsilon_i e_i^*} \approx e_i^* \left[1 + \varepsilon_i(1 - \pi_i) - \frac{1}{2} \varepsilon_i(1 - \pi_i)^2 \right]. \quad (5)$$

190 *Proof.* Equating $y_i - a_i(e_i^*) + (r_i - e_i^*)p^*$ with $y_i - a_i(e_i^A)$ gives $r_i = e_i^* + [a_i(e_i^*) -$
 191 $a_i(e_i^A)]/p^*$. Substituting $a_i'(e_i^*) = -p^*$ into (2) yields (3). Equation (4) follows
 192 from $e_i^A - e_i^* \approx \varepsilon_i e_i^*(1 - \pi_i)$. For (5), note that $a_i''(e_i^*) = -1/e_i'(p^*) = p^*/(\varepsilon_i e_i^*)$,
 193 so that $b_i \approx \frac{1}{2} p^* (e_i^A - e_i^*)^2 / (\varepsilon_i e_i^*)$. $\square$

194 Proposition 1 shows that a differentiated price is equivalent to a transfer paid
 195 in kind. Relative to the uniform price, a country allowed a lower price ($\pi_i < 1$)
 196 keeps emissions $e_i^A > e_i^*$. To first order, the uniform-price regime replicates its sit-
 197 uation by granting it exactly those emissions as rights, part of which it then sells,
 198 receiving $(e_i^A - e_i^*)p^*$. Conversely, a country asked for a higher price ($\pi_i > 1$)
 199 is in the position of a country that buys rights. The size of the implicit transfer
 200 grows with the price gap, the country's emissions and the elasticity of those emis-
 201 sions. The same formula, read in reverse, converts any allocation of rights into
 202 an equivalent autarky price.

203 It is convenient to express an allocation as a multiple of the world average,
 204 $r_i = \rho_i \bar{e}$, so that $\rho_i = 1$ is an equal per capita allocation. We denote by $\rho_i^* \equiv r_i^* / \bar{e}$

205 the equivalent ratio, and by $\hat{\rho}_i$ its first-order approximation:

$$\hat{\rho}_i \equiv \frac{e_i^A}{\bar{e}}, \quad (6)$$

206 country i 's per capita emissions under the differentiated schedule relative to the
 207 world average. By (3), $\rho_i^* = \hat{\rho}_i - b_i/(p^*\bar{e}) \leq \hat{\rho}_i$: the first-order prediction errs on
 208 the generous side. A differentiated schedule is thus, to first order, a grandfather-
 209 ing rule, applied to the emissions that the schedule itself induces.

210 **Proposition 2** (Dominance of the uniform price). *Allocate rights $r_i = e_i^A$ to every*
 211 *country. This allocation (i) is feasible at the cap of the autarky regime, $\sum_i N_i r_i = E$; (ii)*
 212 *leaves every country weakly better off than under the autarky regime if a_i is convex; and*
 213 *(iii) leaves a surplus of $\sum_i N_i b_i \geq 0$. Expressed in emissions, the rights can be cut to the*
 214 *equivalent allocation $(r_i^*)_i$, with no country worse off than under differentiated prices.*

215 *Proof.* Part (i) holds by construction. For part (ii), the consumption gain of coun-
 216 try i is $[a_i(e_i^A) - a_i(e_i^*)] + (e_i^A - e_i^*)p^* = b_i \geq 0$. For part (iii), sum these gains. $\square$

217 A country that is allowed a lower price saves on abatement costs. Under the
 218 uniform price, the same country can abate up to p^* and sell the freed rights at p^* ,
 219 which is always at least as good a deal. By Proposition 1, the surplus is of second
 220 order in the price gaps, whereas the implicit transfers are of first order. The ratio
 221 of the two therefore grows with price dispersion: the larger a schedule's price
 222 gaps, the more consumption it loses per dollar of implicit transfer.

223 The equivalent rights r_i^* of Proposition 1 leave country i indifferent at a fixed
 224 price p^* . Turning the surplus into a lower cap raises the price, so that the rights
 225 $\tilde{r}_i$ that leave every country indifferent at the reduced cap and at the price it in-
 226 duces, with ratio $\tilde{\rho}_i \equiv \tilde{r}_i/\bar{e}$, are slightly greater than r_i^* . Therefore, the attainable

emissions cut differs from $\sum_i N_i b_i / p^*$; we solve for it, and for $\tilde{\rho}_i$, numerically in Section 5.

Proposition 2 is a first-best statement that abstracts from the second-best rationales for differentiation reviewed in Section 2, none of which requires the absence of transfers. What it questions is the argument that differentiation is needed because transfers would be infeasible: differentiation has the same distributive outcome as well-chosen transfers; it only makes them implicit.

3.2 Dynamic setting

With several periods, variables become trajectories indexed by t , and β_t denotes the reduced-form discount factor on consumption. Under total utilitarianism, country i 's reduced-form objective is $\sum_t \beta_t N_{it} c_{it}$. It is therefore convenient to state the dynamic results in totals rather than per capita, denoted by upper-case letters: $R_{it} \equiv N_{it} r_{it}$ and $E_{it} \equiv N_{it} e_{it}$ are country i 's rights and emissions in period t , E_{it}^A its emissions under the autarky regime, and $E_t = \sum_i E_{it}$ world emissions.

Proposition 3 (Dynamic equivalence). *Suppose abatement costs are separable over time. To first order in the price gaps $p_{it} - p_t^*$, country i is indifferent between the autarky regime and the uniform price path (p_t^*) with rights (R_{it}) if and only if*

$$\sum_t \beta_t p_t^* (R_{it} - E_{it}^A) = 0. \quad (7)$$

If rights are a constant multiple ρ_i of an equal per capita share, $r_{it} = \rho_i \bar{e}_t$, the equivalent ratio is, to first order,

$$\hat{\rho}_i = \frac{\sum_t \beta_t p_t^* N_{it} e_{it}^A}{\sum_t \beta_t p_t^* N_{it} \bar{e}_t} : \quad (8)$$

the country's emissions under autarky over its population share of world emissions, each

247 period weighted by the discounted price.

248 **Corollary 1** (Hotelling case). *If the discounted price $\beta_t p_t^*$ is constant over time, the*
 249 *dynamic equivalence (7) only constrains cumulative rights $R_i \equiv \sum_t R_{it}$, which must*
 250 *equal the country's carbon budget under the autarky regime. If differentiated prices are*
 251 *homothetic, $p_{it} = \pi_i p_t^*$, this budget admits a first-order approximation as a function of*
 252 *the price ratio π_i , analogous to the static case:*

$$R_i \approx E_i^A \approx E_i^* \left[1 + \varepsilon_i (1 - \pi_i) \right], \quad (9)$$

253 where $E_i^* \equiv \sum_t E_{it}^*$ (resp. $E_i^A \equiv \sum_t E_{it}^A$) denotes i 's cumulative emissions under the
 254 uniform price (resp. autarky), and $\varepsilon_i \equiv \sum_t \varepsilon_{it} E_{it}^* / E_i^*$ denotes the average over time,
 255 weighted by these emissions, of its price elasticities ε_{it} at p_t^* . Consequently,

$$\hat{\rho}_i = \frac{E_i^A}{\sum_t \frac{N_{it}}{N_t} E_t}, \quad (10)$$

256 that is, the ratio of country i 's share of the cumulative emissions under autarky to its
 257 equal per capita share of the world carbon budget.

258 *Proof.* Apply the first-order argument of Proposition 1 period by period. In pe-
 259 riod t the consumption gain per capita is $p_t^*(r_{it} - e_{it}^A)$ to first order; under total
 260 utilitarianism it enters the country's objective multiplied by its population, which
 261 turns per capita quantities into totals, and it is discounted by β_t . Summing over
 262 t and setting the total to zero gives (7). Substituting $R_{it} = \rho_i (N_{it}/N_t) E_t$ into (7)
 263 gives (8), and $\beta_t p_t^*$ cancels from it when it is constant, leaving (10). Likewise, a
 264 constant $\beta_t p_t^*$ factors out of (7), which then reads $\sum_t (R_{it} - E_{it}^A) = 0$. If $p_{it} = \pi_i p_t^*$,
 265 then (4) applied in each period gives $E_{it}^A \approx E_{it}^* [1 + \varepsilon_{it} (1 - \pi_i)]$, and summing over
 266 t gives (9). □

267 Proposition 3 and Corollary 1 assume that international transfers do not alter
268 future state variables such as the capital stock; NICE, in which transfers affect in-
269 vestment and growth, therefore extends them quantitatively beyond this setting.

270 Equation (7) shows that timing matters. A tonne of rights is worth more in a
271 period of high (discounted) prices, so the allocation depends on the whole price
272 path, and a country's cumulative carbon budget does not by itself determine its
273 welfare. With a constant carbon price, the discounted price falls over time, and
274 countries whose emissions fall quickly under autarky need more rights than their
275 cumulative share suggests, because the discounted price is higher in the short
276 term when their emissions are high. Only under a Hotelling price path, the natu-
277 ral benchmark with a fixed carbon budget and efficient capital markets, does the
278 price weighting drop out, and (9) then states that a differentiated price is worth
279 to a country the domestic carbon budget it induces. Because rights are defined as
280 a per capita multiple rather than a share of global emissions, equation (10) also
281 carries a demographic correction.

282 4 Equivalent rights by country

283 4.1 Model

284 We use NICE (Young-Brun et al. 2025), a recursive-dynamic integrated assess-
285 ment model in the RICE tradition (itself an offshoot of DICE). It represents 179
286 countries, each disaggregated into income deciles with specific carbon footprints
287 and climate damages, and is coupled to the FaIR climate model. International
288 transfers enter national income and therefore affect investment and subsequent
289 growth. Damages are country-specific: the damage function is applied to local

temperatures. All countries share the same cost function of the abatement rate but differ only through their baseline emissions. A given price therefore induces the same proportional abatement everywhere, so that the price elasticity ε_i of Proposition 1 is common to all countries at a given price, and cross-country differences in equivalent rights stem from differences in emissions and in autarky prices. Online Appendix A gives further details.

We present every result under two variants, which differ in how a country's situation is measured and in how carbon revenue is shared within it. In the *consumption* variant, we compare a country's situation in two regimes by the net present value over 2025–2100, discounted at 3% a year, of its total consumption. Domestic carbon revenues are recycled within each country in proportion to c^η , the inverse of marginal utility (Negishi weights, with $\eta = 1.5$). This rule is our benchmark because it roughly preserves within-country inequality, which the criterion ignores, so that the comparisons isolate between-country effects. In the *welfare* variant, the criterion is the net present value of population-weighted equally-distributed-equivalent (EDE) consumption,³ with inequality aversion $\eta = 1.5$, and revenues are returned as an equal per capita dividend within each country, which makes the domestic incidence of a carbon price progressive. Pricing carbon then reduces within-country inequality and can improve welfare even ignoring avoided climate damages, an effect that makes this variant unsuited to isolating the inefficiency of differentiated pricing. We show the consumption variant in the main text, report the main figures of the welfare variant alongside, and give its full results in Online Appendix B.

³EDE consumption is the level of consumption which, equally distributed across deciles, would yield the same utilitarian welfare as the actual distribution.

313 4.2 Design

314 The benchmark is an exponential uniform price path p_t^* , ramped up linearly from
 315 zero in 2025 over ten years and growing at a constant rate from 2036, which ex-
 316 haunts a carbon budget of 1000 GtCO₂ over 2025–2100. Among such paths, we
 317 take the one that maximises discounted world welfare, damages included, over
 318 2025–2300.⁴ The ramp-up reaches \$192/t in 2035, after which the price grows
 319 at 1.3% a year, reaching \$229/t in 2050 and \$429/t in 2100. World emissions
 320 fall from 38 GtCO₂ in 2025 to 27 in 2030, 20 in 2035 and 2 in 2100, and warm-
 321 ing reaches 1.84°C in 2100.⁵ The price grows more slowly than the 3% discount
 322 rate, so that the discounted price falls over time: with damages in the objective, a
 323 tonne abated early is worth more than the carbon budget alone would imply. For
 324 a given country i , we compare two scenarios with the same global emission path.

- 325 • *Autarky*: country i applies $\pi_i p_t^*$ and recycles its revenue domestically. The
 326 rest of the world applies a uniform price that we solve for year by year so
 327 that global emissions stay on the path of the uniform-price run.
- 328 • *Uniform price*: all countries apply p_t^* . Country i receives rights per capita ρ_i
 329 times its population share of global emissions in the same year, $r_{it} = \rho_i \bar{e}_t$,
 330 and the remaining rights go to the rest of the world in proportion to each
 331 country's emissions.

332 A grid over (π_i, ρ_i) gives the net gain between the two scenarios, and hence
 333 country i 's indifference curve. We run the grid for seven diverse economies.

⁴Welfare is discounted at a pure rate of time preference of 0.3%, which, with $\eta = 1.5$ and the model's 1.8% annual growth of consumption per capita, corresponds to the 3% discount rate on consumption used throughout.

⁵This 47% fall over 2025–2035 is ambitious but in line with existing domestic pathways: the EU's 2030 target amounts to a 40% cut over 2019–2030, and the pathway consistent with China's goal of CO₂ neutrality by 2060 cuts its emissions by 54% over 2035–2045 (Du et al. 2026).

334 4.3 Results

335 Figure 1 maps each country's consumption gain in the uniform-price regime rel-
 336 ative to autarky over the (π_i, ρ_i) plane, in the consumption variant; Figure A1 in
 337 Online Appendix B is its welfare-variant analogue. Its indifference curve gives,
 338 for each autarky price factor, the smallest rights allocation at which the country
 339 prefers the uniform price. The first panel repeats the United States with the y-axis
 340 on a linear rather than a logarithmic scale: the curve is then close to a straight line,
 341 as equation (4) implies.

342 **Cumulative emissions predict equivalent rights.** The intercept of each curve at
 343 $\pi_i = 1$, denoted ρ_1^* , is consistent with the theory: when the autarky price equals
 344 the uniform price, the equivalent rights closely match the first-order approxi-
 345 mation (8) based on the country's cumulative emissions (Table 1).⁶ Equivalent
 346 rights account for projected future emissions, which a 2025 snapshot does not. In
 347 2025, India emits 0.4 times the world average per capita, but it is equivalent to
 348 0.72 shares, because its emissions hold up while the world's fall. Conversely, the
 349 EU27, at 1.7 times the world average in 2025, is equivalent to 1.54 shares, because
 350 its emissions fall faster than the world's.

351 **Fair allocations cannot be replicated by differentiated prices.** While every price
 352 schedule has an equivalent allocation, not every allocation has an equivalent non-
 353 negative price. At a zero price, a country cannot emit more than its unabated
 354 emissions, so this is the most that differentiation can offer. For low emitters,

⁶The residual gaps are due to the homotheticity constraint on rights ($r_{it} = \rho_i \bar{e}$), which creates temporary price gaps that in turn trigger channels ignored by the first-order formula: the convexity of abatement costs, the effect of transfers on capital accumulation, and the within-country incidence of prices and transfers.

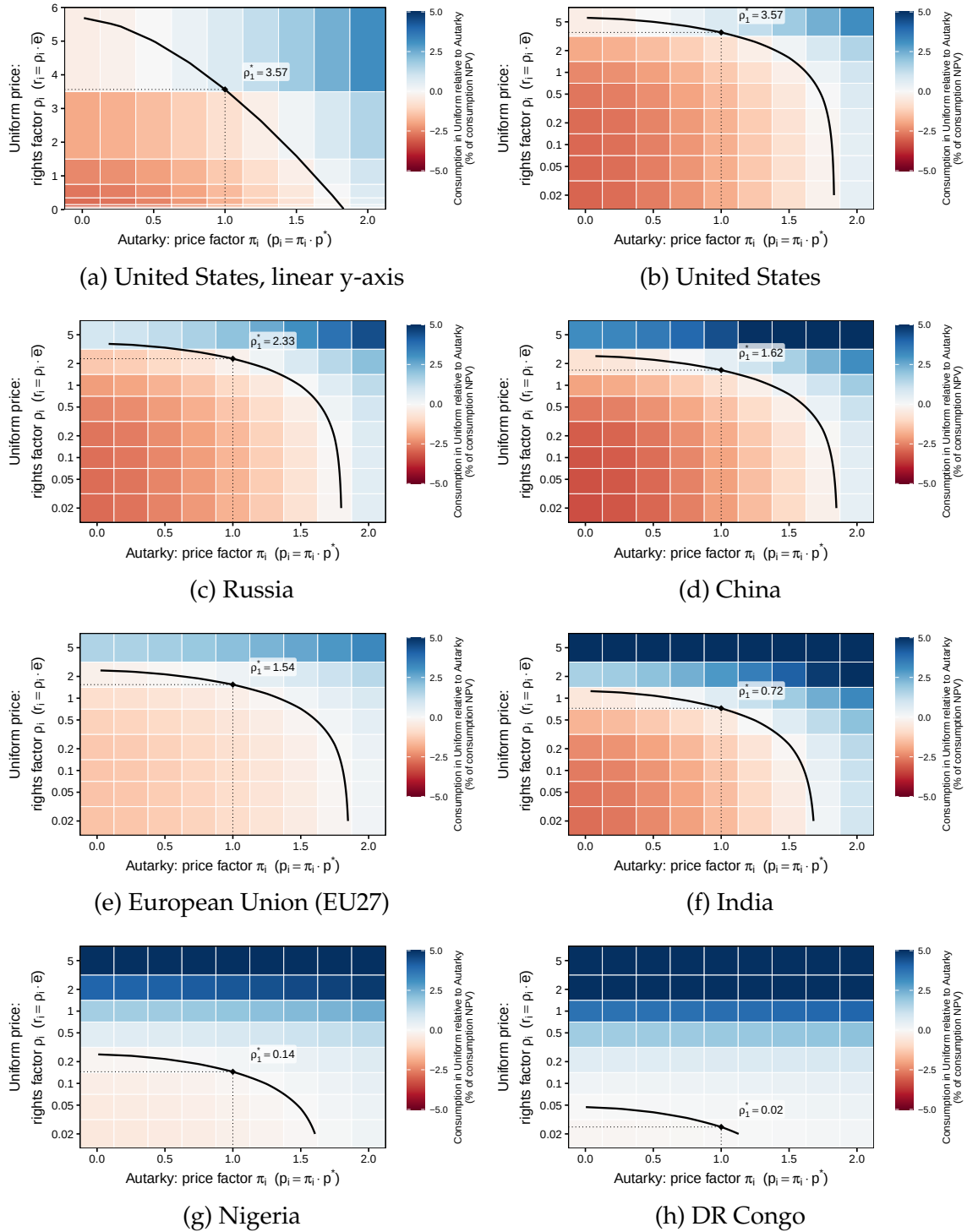


Figure 1: Consumption gain of the uniform-price regime over autarky.

Note: The horizontal axis is country i 's autarky price as a multiple π_i of the benchmark price p_i^* . The vertical axis is its allocation ρ_i under the uniform price, as a multiple of world average emissions per capita: on a log scale in every panel but the first. Colours give the net gain in the uniform regime relative to autarky in terms of NPV of consumption over 2025–2100, in percent; blue cells are those where the uniform price is preferred to autarky. The black line is the indifference curve and ρ_i^* its value at $\pi_i = 1$. Global emissions are the same in both regimes at every point of the grid. Crosses mark allocations that would leave the rest of the world with negative rights.

Table 1: Allocation at which each country is indifferent when the autarky price equals the benchmark ($\pi_i = 1$).

	Emissions p.c. in 2025 (tCO ₂)	Emissions p.c. in 2025 over world average	Predicted $\hat{\rho}_1$	Simulated ρ_1^*
United States	17.65	3.77	3.56	3.57
Russia	9.92	2.12	2.33	2.33
EU27	8.07	1.73	1.54	1.54
China	7.22	1.54	1.62	1.62
Turkey	4.86	1.04	1.33	1.33
India	1.91	0.41	0.73	0.72
Nigeria	0.59	0.13	0.15	0.14
DR Congo	0.05	0.01	0.03	0.02

Note: $\hat{\rho}_1$ is equation (8) evaluated on the uniform-price run: the country’s emissions over its population share of world emissions, each year weighted by the discounted benchmark price over 2025–2100. ρ_1^* is the value of the indifference curve in Figure 1 at $\pi_i = 1$.

that bound lies far below an equal per capita share: 0.25 for Nigeria and 0.05 for the DRC. Burden-sharing principles that give such countries an equal per capita share or more — as historical responsibility or capacity to pay would — can only be achieved through a cap-and-trade or through monetary transfers.

5 Equivalent rights of prominent differentiation proposals

5.1 Proposals

We feed three proposals into the model as country-level price schedules.

363 Wolfram et al. (2025) envisage a coalition of 47 countries⁷ including China,
364 the EU, the UK, India and Brazil, which together emit 49% of world CO₂ in 2030.
365 Members apply \$75, \$50 and \$25/t in high-, upper-middle- and lower-income
366 countries, the tiers of the IMF's international carbon price floor (Parry et al. 2021).
367 The proposal targets four emissions-intensive industries, whereas NICE has no
368 sectoral detail. We apply the floors economy-wide, so our scenario is more ambi-
369 tious than the one the authors model.

370 Banerjee et al. (2025) propose \$10, \$30 and \$50/t in low-, lower-middle- and
371 upper-middle-income countries, in exchange for compensation for climate dam-
372 ages, with revenues retained domestically. High-income countries fund the com-
373 pensation and are expected to price carbon heavily, but the proposal gives no
374 figure. Rather than leaving them unpriced, we price them at \$75/t, the top tier of
375 Parry et al. (2021) and Wolfram et al. (2025).

376 Equal Right (2023) proposes a global system to phase out fossil fuel extrac-
377 tion that can be modelled as a schedule of differentiated prices. Each country
378 sells its extraction licences at a price graduated by income group (\$240, \$120, \$60
379 and \$30/t) and discounted by up to 60% for climate vulnerability, which gives
380 floors ranging from \$12 to \$240/t in 2025 (\$138/t on average), rising by about
381 16% a year to stay within 1.5°C. The revenues are pooled in a global fund that
382 pays climate grants and a universal dividend. We model Equal Right's between-
383 country transfers by returning global revenues to each country in proportion to
384 its population.

385 The first two proposals do not specify how prices evolve over time. Parry et al.

⁷The members are Algeria, Australia, Brazil, Cameroon, Canada, China, Egypt, the European Union, Ghana, Iceland, India, Indonesia, Kenya, Liechtenstein, Mozambique, Norway, Switzerland, Thailand, Togo, the United Kingdom, Uganda and Zambia.

(2021) set their floors for 2030, Wolfram et al. (2025) simulate a single illustrative year and suggest “sunset provisions that gradually raise lower-tier prices so countries ‘graduate’ into a single uniform price”, and Banerjee et al. (2025) raise a country’s price only when it moves to a higher income group. For each proposal, we hold the announced prices from 2025 through 2030 and raise them by 5% a year thereafter, capped at the backstop price. While Wolfram et al. (2025) and Banerjee et al. (2025) include unquantified provisions to make prices converge, we do not model them, so as to compare differentiated prices with a cap-and-trade on clear terms. In Online Appendix C, we also run Equal Right’s original escalation path, which reaches the backstop in most countries by 2050. The proposals yield a 2100 warming of 2.22°C (Wolfram et al. 2025), 1.87°C (Banerjee et al. 2025) and 1.67°C (Equal Right 2023).

5.2 Design

We compare each differentiation proposal with a cap-and-trade. Countries the proposal prices form a coalition whose members face a uniform price p_t^* , calibrated so that their joint emissions equal those under differentiation. This price is \$51/t (Wolfram et al. 2025), \$56/t (Banerjee et al. 2025) and \$143/t (Equal Right 2023) in 2030. It then grows by 4–5% a year, slightly less than the 5% of the schedules due to a composition effect: emissions shift towards the members with the lowest prices, which weigh more and more in the average price. Non-members are unpriced in both regimes. Member i receives rights per capita $r_{it} = \rho_i \bar{e}_t$, where $\bar{e}_t$ is the coalition’s emissions per capita under the proposal, so that $\rho_i = 1$ is an equal per capita allocation. This design differs from that of Section 4 in two respects: the uniform price is not the benchmark path of Section 4 but the coal-

410 tion price that reproduces the proposal's emissions, and allocations are expressed
411 relative to the coalition's emissions per capita rather than the world's.

412 We solve for the equivalent ratios in each of the two variants of Section 4: on
413 the NPV of each member's total consumption, with Negishi recycling, and on
414 the NPV of its EDE consumption (or *welfare*), with an equal per capita dividend
415 within countries (Online Appendix B). Proposition 2 implies that the coalition
416 regime leaves a surplus, which we use in either of two ways:

417 • *Reduced emissions*: rights are cut (hence the price and abatement costs in-
418 crease) until every member is as well off as under the proposal, which
419 yields the ratios $\tilde{p}_i$ of Section 3. This is our benchmark. As in Proposi-
420 tions 1 and 2, members are compared at the same damages: while solving
421 for the allocation, we hold each country's damages at the level implied by
422 the proposal's own temperature path.⁸ Once the rights are computed, we
423 reintegrate avoided damages into the consumption (or welfare) gains we
424 report.

425 • *Increased consumption*: joint emissions are kept at their level under the pro-
426 posal in every year, and the surplus rights are shared so as to maximise
427 the smallest relative gain of any member, which equalises the gains of all
428 members.

429 We solve each problem jointly for all members. At each iteration, the allocation
430 sets the cap, the coalition price is recalibrated to deliver it, and each member's
431 ratio is updated to improve the criterion. We iterate until convergence. Online

⁸This is an accounting device used to isolate the efficiency gain of uniform pricing. If the price is below the social cost of carbon, accounting for avoided damages would tighten the cap past the social cost of carbon, until the extra abatement costs offset the climate benefits of the earlier cuts. Reduced emissions would then measure the ambition of a proposal rather than the instrument used to deliver it.

432 Appendix A also reports two alternative ways of sharing the consumption sur-
433 plus, and an *isolated* solve, which finds each country's ratio in turn while every
434 other member pays the coalition price and is granted its own emissions under the
435 proposal as rights.

436 5.3 Results

437 Table 2 reports, for ten major economies, the allocation equivalent to each pro-
438 posal, solved on consumption, together with the outcome of the two ways of
439 using the surplus. For the schedule of Banerjee et al. (2025), it also reports the net
440 transfer that the equivalent allocation implies.

Table 2: Equivalent rights of three differentiated-price schedules, and the surplus of a uniform price.

Country	Banerjee, Duflo & Greenstone				Wolfram et al.		Equal Right, 5%/yr	
	p_{2030}	$\hat{\rho}$	$\tilde{\rho}$	τ (%)	p_{2030}	$\tilde{\rho}$	p_{2030}	$\tilde{\rho}$
United States	75	2.63	2.51	-0.39	0	-	240	-0.16
Russia	75	1.71	1.61	-0.38	0	-	240	0.12
European Union (average)	75	1.17	1.11	-0.19	75	0.95	232	0.31
China	50	1.61	1.60	-0.02	50	1.39	108	1.13
Turkey	50	1.28	1.29	-0.03	0	-	108	0.99
Indonesia	50	0.90	0.91	-0.05	50	0.77	96	0.91
Brazil	50	0.41	0.41	-0.02	50	0.36	108	0.78
India	30	1.00	0.92	0.52	25	0.86	42	1.17
Nigeria	30	0.21	0.19	0.09	0	-	42	0.76
DR Congo	10	0.08	0.05	0.12	0	-	15	0.68
<i>Reduced emissions: every member as well off as under the proposal (ignoring avoided damages)</i>								
World temp. 2100, change (°C)			-0.018			-0.012		-0.036
Emissions change in the coalition (%)			-3.9%			-4.8%		-13.4%
Post-damage consumption gain (%)			0.029%			0.027%		0.095%
<i>Increased consumption: coalition emissions as under the proposal</i>								
Coalition consumption gain (in %)			0.053%			0.059%		0.189%

Note: p_{2030} is the price under differentiation. $\tilde{\rho}$ is the country's equivalent rights as a multiple of the coalition's emissions per capita under differentiation, from the joint solve in its reduced-emissions form, on the consumption criterion. $\hat{\rho}$ is the first-order prediction of equation (8). τ is the implicit transfer that differentiation implies, i.e. the value of the country's net sales of rights at the coalition price, assuming its rights are its emissions under differentiation (in percent of its NPV of consumption). Under Equal Right's proposal, revenue is pooled worldwide and returned in proportion to population, which is why its equivalent rights are so much lower for large per capita emitters and can even be negative. The surplus of uniform pricing can be taken either as *reduced emissions* or *increased consumption*.

441 **The surplus as reduced emissions.** The uniform-price equivalent allocation of
442 the Banerjee et al. differentiation reduces global emissions by 3.9% and its 2100
443 warming by 0.02°C, while preserving pre-damage consumption in every coun-
444 try. Reduced warming then makes every country better off than under differen-
445 tiation, except for Mongolia, which would actually benefit from extra warming,
446 according to our model: it loses 0.01% of its consumption, which could be com-
447 pensated by extra rights amounting to 0.001% of global 2025–2100 emissions.

448 The corresponding emission cuts are 4.8% for Wolfram et al. (2025) and 13.4%

449 for the Equal Right schedule. In the welfare variant the cut is far larger (21%
450 for Banerjee et al.), but mostly because a higher coalition price funds a larger
451 equal per capita dividend, whose redistribution within each member the welfare
452 criterion values (Online Appendix B).

453 **The surplus as increased consumption.** Keeping emissions at their level un-
454 der differentiation and sharing the surplus so as to equalise gains, every country
455 gains 0.053% of the net present value of its consumption vis-à-vis Banerjee et al.'s
456 proposal.

457 **The equivalent rights.** For the Banerjee et al. schedule, the first-order predic-
458 tion $\hat{p}_i$ of equation (8) reproduces the solved allocations closely. As Proposition 1
459 implies, it errs on the generous side for most countries, and by most for those
460 priced furthest below the uniform price, whose second-order term is largest: 1.00
461 against 0.92 for India, 0.08 against 0.05 for the DRC.

462 The equivalent rights track the two determinants of Proposition 1: a country's
463 emissions, and the gap between the price it is asked to apply and the coalition
464 price of \$56/t. The United States and Russia, priced at \$75/t and emitting well
465 above the world average, need 2.51 and 1.61 shares; China, priced at \$50/t, needs
466 1.60; India, at \$30/t, 0.92; Nigeria, at the same price but emitting a quarter as
467 much per capita, 0.19. The schedule of Wolfram et al. (2025) gives a similar picture
468 among its 47 members. The Equal Right schedule, whose revenue does not stay
469 at home, is a different matter.

470 **The implicit transfers from differentiation.** Column τ of Table 2 gives the im-
471 plicit transfers of the Banerjee et al. (2025) schedule, $\tau_i = \sum_t \beta_t p_t^* (E_{it}^A - E_{it}^*)$, the

472 present value of the rights country i would sell (or buy) if granted its emissions
 473 under the schedule, expressed in percent to the present value of its consumption.
 474 They amount to -0.39% for the United States, -0.02% for China and $+0.52\%$ for
 475 India. Summed over the net recipients, the gross implicit transfers are 0.11% of
 476 the coalition's consumption in present value, about twice the efficiency gain of
 477 0.05% . Their yearly flow grows with the carbon price, from 0.04% of the coali-
 478 tion's consumption in 2030 to 0.12% in 2050, when India receives 0.47% of its
 479 consumption and the United States pays 0.41% of its own.

480 **A schedule with a global dividend.** Under Equal Right the carbon price rev-
 481 enue is pooled globally and returned to every country in proportion to popu-
 482 lation, so the equivalent allocation has to replace what the schedule charges a
 483 country *and* what the fund pays it. To first order, a member is indifferent when
 484 $p_t^* R_{it} = p_t^* E_{it}^A + D_t N_{it}/N_t - p_{it} E_{it}^A$, with $D_t = \sum_j p_{jt} E_{jt}^A$ the world revenue and
 485 $p_{it} E_{it}^A$ the revenue forgone from domestic pricing. Denoting by $\bar{p}_t \equiv D_t/E_t$ the
 486 average price paid under differentiation, the dividend is therefore worth not one
 487 equal per capita share but $\bar{p}/p^*$, about 0.65 under this schedule. This ratio is be-
 488 low one for two reasons. First, the allocation of Table 2 takes the surplus of uni-
 489 form pricing as reduced emissions: the cap is 13.4% below the schedule's emis-
 490 sions, so the coalition price is higher than the uniform price that would deliver
 491 the schedule's own emissions, and in present value the latter is only 0.86 of the
 492 former. Second, there is a composition effect: at equal emissions, the members
 493 charged $\$240/t$ abate almost everything, so that the tonnes that survive increas-
 494 ingly sit in the $\$15\text{--}42/t$ tiers (most of them from the 2060s), and the emission-
 495 weighted mean price falls to 0.76 of the uniform price.

496 A member that emits almost nothing therefore has an equivalent rights ra-

497 tio near $\bar{p}/p^*$ rather than one, which is why the DRC's ratio (0.68) is well below
498 one. In the increased-consumption allocation, whose coalition price delivers the
499 schedule's own emissions, only the composition effect remains and the DRC's
500 ratio is 0.85. It remains below one, as does Nigeria's (0.97), whereas India (1.39),
501 China (1.21) and Indonesia (1.13) are above one. Counterintuitively, when rev-
502 enue is pooled globally and returned equally, price differentiation thus leaves the
503 lowest emitters worse off than a uniform price with equal per capita rights de-
504 livering the same emissions: the highest prices drive the high-income countries'
505 emissions they apply to, and hence the revenue they raise for the fund, close to
506 zero.

507 For six countries, the equivalent ratio is negative, e.g. -0.16 for the United
508 States. Matching the schedule then requires these countries to buy the rights to all
509 their emissions and to pay a further sum, so that the equivalent of the schedule is
510 a net payment rather than an allocation of rights. Net payments are what burden-
511 sharing principles based on historical responsibility would call for (Fanning and
512 Hickel 2023).

513 6 Conclusion

514 Differentiating carbon prices by income is increasingly proposed as a way to rec-
515 oncile carbon pricing with equity. Yet a differentiated schedule is equivalent, to
516 first order, to a uniform price with tradable rights that grandfather each country
517 on the emissions the schedule itself induces. Differentiation is thus equivalent
518 to transfers of the same first-order size, implicit in (excess or forgone) abatement
519 rather than paid in money. Moreover, since abatement costs are convex, the ex-

520 plicit version leaves every country better off.

521 Replacing the differentiated prices of [Wolfram et al. \(2025\)](#) or [Banerjee et al.](#)
522 [\(2025\)](#) with a uniform price at equivalent rights would cut the coalition's emis-
523 sions by 4–5% while leaving every member as well off as under differentiation,
524 and by 13% under the more dispersed schedule of [Equal Right \(2023\)](#). Alterna-
525 tively, at unchanged emissions, it would raise every member's consumption, by
526 0.05–0.06% for the first two schedules and 0.19% for the third. These efficiency
527 gains may seem small, but they should be compared with the implicit transfers
528 of differentiation. Under the schedule of [Banerjee et al. \(2025\)](#), the gross implicit
529 transfers amount in present value to 0.11% of the coalition's consumption, so that
530 differentiation loses about half a dollar of consumption for every dollar of im-
531 plicit transfer. The choice is therefore between implicit transfers, at that cost, and
532 explicit transfers, which a uniform price with equivalent rights delivers without
533 it.

534 The equivalence runs only one way. Every schedule of prices has an equiv-
535 alent allocation of rights, but no schedule of non-negative prices can deliver to
536 a low emitter what a generous allocation would: even a zero price leaves Nige-
537 ria below 26% of an equal per capita share, and the DRC below 5%. Allocations
538 based on equal per capita rights, historical responsibility or capacity to pay are
539 therefore out of reach of price differentiation.

540 Two implications follow for negotiations. First, the equivalence formula pro-
541 vides a near-linear correspondence between a price and emission rights, allowing
542 parties to shift the discussion from one notion to the other as needed. Second, the
543 value of national sovereignty invoked to dismiss an international cap-and-trade
544 should be weighed against the efficiency gains of an international commitment.

545 Furthermore, survey evidence shows that 85% of respondents worldwide state
546 that climate policy at the *global* level is needed, at odds with the supposed taste
547 for national sovereignty (Fabre et al. 2025). Finally, robust majority acceptance of
548 an international cap-and-trade funding equal per capita cash transfers indicates
549 that most people are ready to accept large North–South transfers that differen-
550 tiated autarky prices cannot deliver. Therefore, price differentiation might be
551 justified only in a transition period towards an international cap-and-trade, as
552 countries build up their administrative capacity.

553 The analysis has limitations. NICE has no capital market, so it cannot capture
554 the diverging capital return motive for differentiation. It has no sectoral detail,
555 which forced us to apply sectoral proposals economy-wide and leaves out the
556 country-specific costs of sectoral reallocation. Extending the equivalence to set-
557 tings with trade and different sectors, where a uniform price must coexist with
558 border adjustments and territorial emissions can be distinguished from carbon
559 footprints, is a natural next step to better inform climate negotiators.

560 **Declaration of competing interest**

561 The authors declare that they have no known competing financial interests or
562 personal relationships that could have appeared to influence the work reported
563 in this paper.

564 **Data availability**

565 The code (Julia, built on the Mimi implementation of NICE) and all inputs needed
566 to reproduce the results are publicly available on [anonymised for review]

567 Declaration of generative AI use

568 During the preparation of this work the authors used Claude Code (Opus 5) to
569 assist with code and editing. The authors reviewed and edited the content and
570 take full responsibility for it.

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Online Appendix

A Solves, sharing rules, and model

Several modelling choices matter for the results: the price path under differentiation; the solve method (*joint* or *isolated*); the criterion (*consumption* or *welfare*); the within-country recycling (*Negishi* or *equal per capita*); the surplus sharing variant (*reduced emissions*, surplus rights allocated to reach an equal increase in consumption, in proportion to marginal utility, or as a uniform rescaling of equivalent rights). Our benchmark choices are in bold.

The two variants. In the consumption variant, all runs use NICE with revenue recycling within each country in proportion to c^{η} , computed once from a uniform-price reference run and held fixed across runs; in the welfare variant, revenue is returned to each country's deciles in equal per capita amounts. Both variants use the default income elasticity of emissions across deciles, emissions measured on a consumption basis (carbon footprints), and international transfers entering national income, hence investment. The same configuration is used in the differentiated and in the uniform-price regime, so that the two regimes differ only in prices and rights.

The two solves. The *joint* solve of the main text finds all ρ_i at once (in its reduced-emissions form, the ratios $\tilde{\rho}_i$). At each iteration the allocation sets the cap, the coalition price is recalibrated to deliver it, and each member's ratio is moved by a secant step on its gap to the target. For the reduced-emissions variant, an outer loop then moves the level of the allocation until the members' common pre-damage gain is zero, so that every member ends exactly at its level under the schedule. The *isolated* solve instead finds each country's ratio in turn, with every other member granted its own emissions under the schedule and the coalition price held at the value that reproduces the schedule's emissions. It is the partial-equilibrium counterpart of Proposition 1, and yields the fixed-price ratios ρ_i^* rather than $\tilde{\rho}_i$: it ignores that the other members also change their allocation, and that the coalition price adjusts to the resulting cap.

The two solves nearly agree on the aggregate. Taking the equivalent allocation at face value cuts the Wolfram et al. coalition's emissions by 4.9% (isolated) against 4.8% (joint), and the Banerjee et al. coalition's by 4.1% against 3.9%. They differ on the distribution, and the difference is systematic. Applied together, the isolated allocations add up to a tighter cap, which raises the uniform price: this raises every member's abatement costs and revalues the rights it trades, to the benefit of net sellers and the detriment of net buyers. The isolated allocations then

leave 33 of 47 Wolfram et al. members and 39 of 179 Banerjee et al. members below their consumption level under the schedule, while the joint allocation leaves none, apart from the effect of avoided damages discussed below (Table A1).

Alternative sharing rules. The increased-consumption variant of the main text shares the surplus so as to maximise the smallest relative gain, which equalises the gains of all members. Two other rules are reported in Table A1. Sharing the surplus in proportion to population times marginal utility directs it to the poorest members: it yields by far the largest inequality-averse gain but, unlike the maximin rule, it leaves 9 of 179 members below their consumption under the schedule. Uniform scaling of the whole allocation is dominated: the extra rights go to the largest holders, and the looser cap lowers the coalition price, which devalues the rights of small, generously endowed net sellers. It leaves no member below on consumption, but its inequality-averse gain is the smallest of the three rules (0.045% for Banerjee et al.), and 9 of 47 Wolfram et al. members and 64 of 179 Banerjee et al. members end below their welfare under the schedule.

Who loses from the avoided damages. The equivalence is solved with damages held at the schedule’s temperature path, and every member is then within 0.001% of indifference. The gains reported in Table 2 are computed with damages endogenous, so they also carry the avoided damages of the tighter cap, which are shared in proportion to each country’s marginal damage $\beta_1 + 2\beta_2 T$. In the Kalkuhl–Wenz specification of NICE, 13 countries have $\beta_1 < 0$, and four of them (Finland, Iceland, Mongolia and Russia) have a local anomaly below $-\beta_1/(2\beta_2)$ in 2100, so that their marginal damage is negative: they gain from warming, and less of it makes them worse off. They are the only members that end below their level under the schedule — Mongolia under Banerjee et al. (2025), and Finland, Iceland, Mongolia and Russia under Equal Right at 5%/yr, ordered by $|\beta_1|$ as the mechanism implies, and none under Wolfram et al. (2025), whose cap moves warming least. The loss is a mirror image of the gain: Nigeria and India, whose marginal damage is largest, gain 0.08% and 0.05% of their consumption from the same avoided warming, against Mongolia’s -0.01% ; compensating Mongolia would take 0.02 more equal per capita shares (0.31% of its allocation).

Abatement beyond 100%. Standard implementations constrain the abatement rate to $\mu \in [0, 1]$. Under high autarky prices, country i ’s price exceeds the backstop price and this constraint binds. In the autarky scenario we extrapolate the cost function beyond $\mu = 1$, which represents carbon dioxide removal at rising marginal cost. The proposals of Section 5 are instead capped at the backstop price.

Table A1: Club-price rights ratios ρ_i equivalent to the Wolfram et al. and Banerjee, Duflo & Greenstone proposals

Country	Wolfram et al.			Banerjee, Duflo & Greenstone		
	p_i	ρ^{isolated}	ρ^{joint}	p_i	ρ^{isolated}	ρ^{joint}
United States	0	–	–	75	2.49	2.51
Russia	0	–	–	75	1.58	1.61
European Union	75	0.90	0.95	75	1.10	1.11
China	50	1.37	1.39	50	1.60	1.60
Turkey	0	–	–	50	1.28	1.29
Indonesia	50	0.76	0.77	50	0.90	0.91
Brazil	50	0.36	0.36	50	0.41	0.41
India	25	0.89	0.86	30	0.92	0.92
Nigeria	0	–	–	30	0.19	0.19
DR Congo	0	–	–	10	0.05	0.05
<i>Reduced emissions (variant 1)</i>						
Emissions change in the coalition (%)		–4.9%	–4.8%		–4.1%	–3.9%
World temp. 2100, change (°C)		–0.013	–0.012		–0.019	–0.018
World welfare gain (%)		0.035%	0.029%		0.056%	0.055%
World consumption gain (%)		0.027%	0.027%		0.029%	0.029%
<i>Increased consumption, equal gains (variant 2)</i>						
World welfare gain (%)		n.a.	0.008%		n.a.	0.053%
World consumption gain (%)		n.a.	0.030%		n.a.	0.053%
<i>Surplus shared by marginal utility (variant 3)</i>						
World welfare gain (%)		0.064%	0.058%		0.244%	0.241%
World consumption gain (%)		0.034%	0.033%		0.058%	0.058%
<i>Surplus shared by uniform scaling (variant 4)</i>						
World welfare gain (%)		0.008%	0.003%		0.043%	0.045%
World consumption gain (%)		0.029%	0.029%		0.052%	0.052%

Note: p_i is the carbon price the proposal asks of country i in 2030; the comparison regime instead prices every member of the proposal's own club at one common price (\$50.6/t for Wolfram et al. and \$56.5/t for Banerjee, Duflo & Greenstone in 2030) and leaves non-members unpriced, as the proposal does. ρ_i is the country's allocation as a multiple of an equal-per-capita share of the club's emissions under the proposal, taken at face value in variant 1; ρ^{isolated} solves each country on its own, ρ^{joint} all of them jointly. The European Union figure aggregates its members' rights, and a country the proposal does not price is outside the club in both regimes, shown at $p_i = 0$ with no equivalent allocation ('–'). Variant 1 (reduced emissions) lets the equivalent allocation set the cap: in the joint solve every member is held exactly at its level under the proposal; in the isolated solve each country's ratio is solved with all others grandfathered, and the ratios are then applied together. Variants 2 to 4 (increased consumption) keep club emissions at the proposal's and share the surplus: so as to equalise the relative gains of all members (variant 2), which requires solving all members jointly and is therefore undefined for the isolated solve (n.a.), in proportion to population times marginal utility (variant 3), and by scaling the allocation up uniformly (variant 4). The temperature row is the change from the proposal's own 2100 warming, which is 2.22°C for Wolfram et al. and 3.87°C for Banerjee, Duflo & Greenstone. World welfare is the NPV of the inequality-averse global EDE consumption ($\eta = 1.5$); world consumption is mean consumption per capita, which weights every person's consumption equally.

B The welfare variant

In the welfare variant, a country's situation is measured by the net present value over 2025–2100 of its population-weighted equally-distributed-equivalent consumption, and the carbon revenue a country keeps (or, under Equal Right, the dividend it receives from the global fund) is returned to its deciles as an equal per capita dividend, in the differentiated and in the uniform regime alike. Everything else — the benchmark price, the schedules and the solves — is as in the consumption variant. Figure A1 is the analogue of Figure 1, and Table A2 reports the joint solves of Table 2 under both variants.

Table A2: Equivalent rights of the three schedules in the two variants (joint solve).

Country	Wolfram et al.			Banerjee, Duflo & Greenstone			Equal Right, 5%/yr		
	p_{2030}	ρ^{cons}	ρ^{welf}	p_{2030}	ρ^{cons}	ρ^{welf}	p_{2030}	ρ^{cons}	ρ^{welf}
United States	0	–	–	75	2.51	2.58	240	–0.16	0.43
European Union	75	0.95	1.04	75	1.11	1.18	232	0.31	0.49
Russia	0	–	–	75	1.61	1.64	240	0.12	0.46
China	50	1.39	1.10	50	1.60	1.29	108	1.13	0.89
Turkey	0	–	–	50	1.29	1.04	108	0.99	0.81
Brazil	50	0.36	0.23	50	0.41	0.28	108	0.78	0.59
Indonesia	50	0.77	0.60	50	0.91	0.72	96	0.91	0.74
India	25	0.86	0.50	30	0.92	0.58	42	1.17	0.80
Nigeria	0	–	–	30	0.19	0.11	42	0.76	0.60
DR Congo	0	–	–	10	0.05	0.02	15	0.68	0.57
<i>Reduced emissions: every member as well off as under the proposal</i>									
World temp. 2100, change (°C)		–0.012	–0.069		–0.018	–0.098		–0.036	–0.076
Emissions change in the coalition (%)		–4.8%	–27.0%		–3.9%	–21.4%		–13.4%	–28.5%
Post-damage consumption gain (%)		0.027%	–0.003%		0.029%	–0.007%		0.095%	–0.051%
Post-damage welfare gain (%)		0.029%	0.320%		0.055%	0.557%		0.080%	0.399%
<i>Increased consumption: coalition emissions as under the proposal</i>									
World consumption gain (%)		0.030%	0.026%		0.053%	0.049%		0.190%	0.185%
World welfare gain (%)		0.008%	0.056%		0.053%	0.242%		0.071%	0.457%

Note: As Table 2, for the two variants. ρ^{cons} : consumption variant (NPV of total consumption, revenue recycled within countries in proportion to c^η), as in Table 2. ρ^{welf} : welfare variant (NPV of population-weighted equally-distributed-equivalent consumption, revenue returned as an equal per capita dividend within countries). Each column is solved on its own criterion, both over 2025–2100; each summary row is computed for both. The consumption gains are computed on world consumption, the welfare gains on the global equally-distributed-equivalent consumption, both with damages endogenous. The schedules reach the same 2100 warming in both variants (2.22°C, 1.87°C and 1.67°C).

The two variants differ through a within-country channel. In NICE, carbon costs fall on deciles in proportion to income raised to an elasticity below one, which is regressive; an equal per capita dividend more than offsets it, so that a carbon price, net of the dividend it funds, redistributes from richer to poorer deciles, which an inequality-averse criterion values. In the consumption variant, the revenue is returned in proportion to c^η and the criterion ignores the distribu-

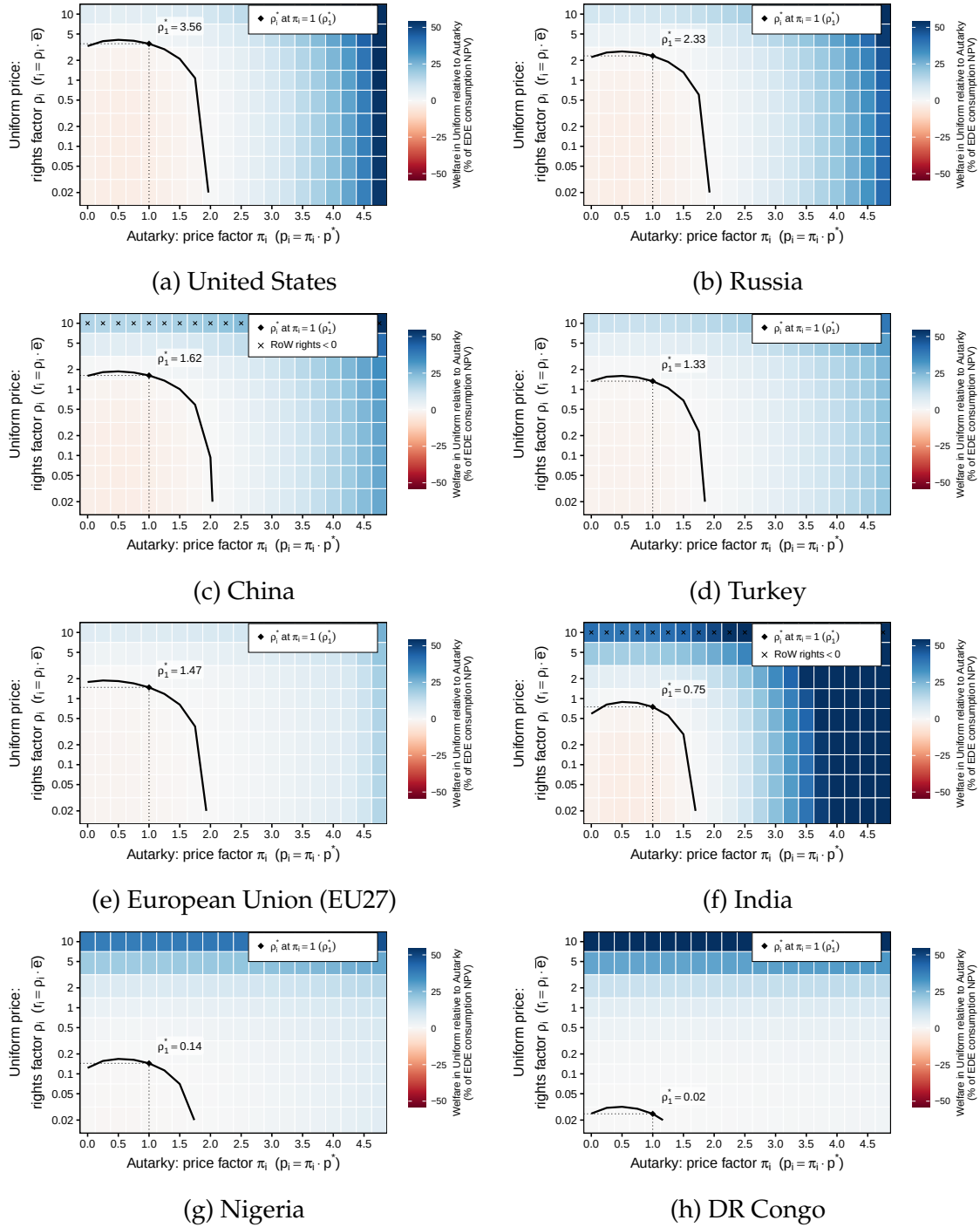


Figure A1: Welfare gain of the uniform-price regime over autarky, welfare variant.

Note: As Figure 1, for the welfare variant: colours give the difference in the NPV of population-weighted equally-distributed-equivalent consumption over 2025–2100, in percent, clipped at ± 54 (the 95th percentile of the absolute difference), and the carbon revenue is returned as an equal per capita dividend within countries in both regimes. The indifference curve is traced from the equivalent allocation solved at each π_i of the grid.

tion across deciles, so that channel is shut down.

Equivalent rights by country. At $\pi_i = 1$ the two variants give nearly the same allocations: ρ_1^* is 3.56 for the United States, 1.62 for China, 1.47 for the EU27, 0.75 for India and 0.14 for Nigeria, within 0.07 of the consumption variant (Table 1). Away from $\pi_i = 1$ they differ. In both regimes the country returns its carbon revenue as an equal per capita dividend, so a domestic carbon price also redistributes from its richer to its poorer deciles, which the welfare criterion values. Compared with an unpriced autarky, the uniform-price regime thus brings the country that redistribution on top of the allocation, and fewer rights are needed to make it indifferent. As π_i rises from zero, autarky brings the same redistribution, so the equivalent allocation rises; beyond $\pi_i \approx 1$, abatement costs dominate and it falls. The equivalent allocation is therefore highest around $\pi_i = 0.5$ –1 rather than at a zero price: 4.08 at $\pi_i = 0.5$ against 3.28 at $\pi_i = 0$ for the United States, 0.17 at most against 0.12 at $\pi_i = 0$ for Nigeria, and 0.03 at most for the DRC. The most that any non-negative price can offer a low emitter is therefore even smaller than in the consumption variant, which strengthens the conclusion of Section 4. This pattern reflects the absence, in the model, of any other instrument of within-country redistribution: a lump-sum redistribution would deliver the same welfare gain without abatement, so the carbon price is here valued in part as a redistributive device.

Equivalent rights of the proposals. The surplus left by uniform pricing is far larger in the welfare variant (Table A2). Converted into lower emissions, it reaches 27.0% of the coalition’s emissions under Wolfram et al. (2025), 21.4% under Banerjee et al. (2025) and 28.5% under Equal Right, against 4.8%, 3.9% and 13.4% in the consumption variant. The equivalent allocations, which add up to these tighter caps, are accordingly lower, and the difference falls mostly on middle- and low-income members (India 0.58 against 0.92 under Banerjee et al., China 1.29 against 1.60), while high emitters keep similar allocations (the United States 2.58 against 2.51). Again, this is not a larger efficiency gain from uniform pricing. The reduced-emissions cut of the welfare variant thus mixes the efficiency gain of uniform pricing with the within-country redistributive value of carbon revenue; the consumption variant isolates the former.

C The Equal Right schedule on its original price path

The Equal Right schedule is designed to rise by about 16% a year, far faster than the 5% we assume for the other two. Table A3 reports it on both paths. On its own path, the schedule pushes most members to full abatement by 2050 and reaches 1.48°C of warming; its coalition price is far above the other schedules', and its allocations are compressed towards an equal per capita share, the dividend of the global fund weighing more heavily the higher the price. The dividend of uniform pricing is larger still: replacing the schedule with the coalition price and the equivalent allocation cuts the coalition's emissions by 14.7%, against 13.4% on the 5%-a-year path. Its effect on 2100 warming is smaller (-0.010°C against -0.036°C), because a schedule that has already driven emissions to zero by mid-century leaves little room for a further cut in cumulative terms.

Table A3: The Equal Right schedule on its own escalation path and at 5% a year.

Country	Equal Right		Equal Right, 5%/yr	
	p_{2030}	$\bar{p}$	p_{2030}	$\bar{p}$
Russia	513	0.22	240	0.12
United States	513	-0.02	240	-0.16
European Union (average)	496	0.35	232	0.31
China	231	1.11	108	1.13
Turkey	231	0.96	108	0.99
Brazil	231	0.77	108	0.78
Indonesia	205	0.87	96	0.91
India	90	1.10	42	1.17
Nigeria	90	0.76	42	0.76
DR Congo	32	0.67	15	0.68
<i>Reduced emissions: every member as well off as under the proposal (ignoring avoided damages)</i>				
World temp. 2100, change ($^{\circ}\text{C}$)		-0.010		-0.036
Emissions change in the coalition (%)		-14.7%		-13.4%
Post-damage consumption gain (%)		0.035%		0.095%
<i>Increased consumption: coalition emissions as under the proposal</i>				
Coalition consumption gain (in %)		0.097%		0.189%

Note: As Table 2, for the Equal Right schedule of price floors grown at its own rate (about 16% a year) and at the 5% a year assumed for the other schedules. Both are run with the proposal's global fund: the revenue of every country is pooled and returned as an equal per capita dividend to the world population.